

Young Ryu, Ph.D.

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UX DIRECTOR & SENIOR PRODUCT DESIGNER

Highly analytical and strategic UX leader with a Ph.D. in Industrial & Systems Engineering (Human Factors) and over a decade of experience driving product design for enterprises and startups. Proven expertise in leading cross-functional teams (UX, UI, Research, Content) to deliver complex B2B and enterprise solutions from discovery to dev-ready design.

Recognized for establishing data-driven user research programs, leading UX Design Sprints, and transforming complex business requirements into intuitive, highly successful digital products.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **UX Strategy & Leadership:** Team Building & Mentorship, Design Sprints, B2B & Enterprise Strategy, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Lean UX Methodologies, Stakeholder Alignment.
- **Product Design:** End-to-End Product Design, UI Design, Highly Interactive Prototyping, Wireframing, Interaction Design, Developer Handoff.
- **Research & Human Factors:** Data-Driven User Research, Usability Testing, Cognitive Psychology, Discovery Research, Analytics Dashboards, Human-Computer Interaction (HCI).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Proto UX LLC | Austin, TX

Principal & Director of UX | Apr 2016 – Present

Founded and led a specialized UX consultancy providing lean, end-to-end design and research services for enterprise and startup clients across web, tablet, and mobile platforms.

- Direct and mentor teams of UX/UI designers, researchers, and content strategists to deliver high-quality, dev-ready product designs.
- Partner with C-suite executives and Product leaders to establish user-centered design methodologies and integrate data-driven UX components into their product development lifecycles.
- Develop and facilitate custom UX & Design Sprint programs for major clients (e.g., ProjectManager.com), directly accelerating time-to-market and product success.
- Lead the research, strategy, and design for highly complex technical tools, including a consumer portal analytics dashboard (New Home Source Professional) and a site-control mobile web application for retail and commercial management (SIEMENS).
- Execute full-lifecycle design processes: discovery research, wireframing, high-fidelity interactive prototyping, usability testing, and final visual design.

Design For Use | Austin, TX

Director of UX (Sep 2014 – Mar 2016)

Senior UX Designer (Mar 2014 – Sep 2014)

Promoted to direct UX initiatives and manage project deliverables for a dedicated user experience agency.

- Directed UX strategy and oversaw the execution of user-centered design solutions for a diverse portfolio of clients.
- Acted as a multi-skilled UX/UI expert, consistently delivering high-quality results and managing complex design scopes under tight, high-pressure deadlines.
- Collaborated closely with engineering and product teams to ensure design feasibility and seamless implementation of digital solutions.

Patient Conversation Media, Inc. | Austin, TX

UX Designer | Sep 2013 – Feb 2014

- Designed user interfaces and user experiences for digital healthcare platforms, focusing on empathy and patient engagement.
- Conducted usability testing and applied user-centered design principles to iterate and improve product features.

Myxer | Austin, TX

Senior UX Designer (UX Strategy & Design Lead) | Sep 2012 – Aug 2013

Aon Hewitt | Greater Chicago Area

Usability Specialist (Contract) | May 2012 – Aug 2012

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Industrial & Systems Engineering (Human Factors Engineering)

Virginia Polytechnic Institute and State University (Virginia Tech)

M.S., Industrial Engineering (Human Factors Lab)

Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (KAIST)

PUBLICATIONS & ACADEMIC CONTRIBUTIONS

Deep domain authority in Human Factors and Usability, bridging the gap between academic rigor and practical product design.

- **Journal Publications:** 8 refereed journal articles published in the *Journal of Usability Studies*, *Ergonomics in Design*, *Journal of Eye Movement Research*, and *Gerontechnology*.
- **Conference Proceedings:** 19 refereed articles published across *ACM*, *IEEE*, *Human Factors and Ergonomics Society (HFES)*, and *HCI International*.